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■ President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan checks the cockpit of Russia's SU57E fighter jet at Dubai Airshow yesterday.



■ His Highness Sheikh Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, inside an aircraft at Dubai Airshow.

Deals galore at Dubai Airshow

EMIRATES AND FLYDUBAI UNVEIL MAJOR AIRCRAFT AND ENGINE ORDERS ON THE OPENING DAY

DUBAI
BY DHANUSHA GOKULAN
Chief Reporter
BY NIVETHA DAYANAND
Assistant Business Editor

Emirates and flydubai unveiled major aircraft and engine orders on the opening day of the Dubai Airshow 2025, signalling a decisive phase of long-term fleet expansion for the two UAE carriers.

The announcements set an early momentum for the show, drawing significant industry attention as manufacturers and suppliers assess global demand recovery.

Meanwhile, Joby drew the day's biggest crowd with a piloted eVTOL flight, its first at an international air show. The 10-minute run showed take-off, hover, and landing sequences, offering a preview of what passengers could experience when

the service launches in Dubai next year.

Emirates announced new orders for 65 Boeing 777-9 aircraft powered by GE9X engines, a commitment valued at \$38 billion at list prices. The deal lifts the airline's total Boeing orderbook to 315 widebody aircraft and increases its GE9X engine orders to 540 units.

The agreement also includes options linked to Boeing's ongoing feasibility study for the 777-10, giving Emirates the flexibility to convert part of its new order to the 777-10 or 777-8 when development decisions are finalised.

Long-term strategy

Sheikh Ahmed Bin Saeed Al Maktoum, Chairman and Chief Executive of Emirates Airline and Group, said the aircraft form part of a long-term fleet and growth strategy aligned with Dubai's transport and tourism ambitions. Emirates expects to begin receiving

EMIRATES TO LAUNCH FREE STARLINK WI-FI

Emirates will roll out ultra-fast Starlink Wi-Fi across its in-service fleet, starting with its Boeing 777 aircraft this month and completing the installation by mid-2027.

The Boeing 777-300ER A6-EPF, currently on display at the Dubai Airshow, is the first Emirates aircraft equipped with Starlink Wi-Fi which will be free for all passengers, across all cabins on equipped aircraft. Access is simple, requiring just one click — no payment or Skywards membership needed. Passengers will be able to stream, game, make calls, work, and browse social media on both personal devices and seatback screens. Live TV via Starlink will roll out initially on personal devices and later on seatback screens from late December 2025.

—Lekshmy Pavithran, Assistant Online Editor

ing its first 777-9 aircraft from the second quarter of 2027.

Boeing leaders described the order as continued confidence in the 777X programme, noting Emirates' role as the world's largest operator of the 777 family. GE Aerospace executives said the additional engine orders reinforce a decades-long partnership and reflect the airline's projected

network growth. Emirates' commitment extends the airline's aircraft delivery horizon to 2038, supporting wide-scale manufacturing activity across multiple US states involved in Boeing's 777X and GE's GE9X production.

flydubai also announced a major step in its expansion plans, signing an agreement with GE Aerospace for 60 GENx-1B en-

gines to power the airline's first wide-body fleet. The order, which includes spare engines and a long-term service package, will support flydubai as it prepares to introduce Boeing 787-9 aircraft into service in the coming years.

The airline, which now operates to more than 135 destinations, is preparing for its first long-haul routes as part of a broader strategy to add capacity and meet rising demand across its network. CEO Ghaith Al Ghaith said the new engines will support the airline's operational performance as it moves into wide-body operations.

Combined, the Emirates and flydubai announcements set the tone for a milestone edition of the Dubai Airshow, underscoring the scale of the UAE aviation sector and the central role both carriers continue to play in shaping global fleet demand.

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Ultra-rare Rolex sells for \$4.72m in record-breaking Dubai auction

Rolex 4113, one of 12 made, smashes model record by over \$1.2m

DUBAI
BY JUSTIN VARGHESE
Your Money Editor

A Rolex Reference 4113 has sold for a world-record \$4.72 million in Dubai, marking one of the most significant Rolex auction results ever recorded and setting the stage for heightened interest ahead of Dubai Watch Week.

FutureGrail, the luxury auction house specialising in rare timepieces who brought the model to auction, said the hammer price exceeded the previous record for a Reference 4113 by more than \$1.2 million. This places the piece ninth on the all-time list of the most expensive Rolex watches ever sold.

Only 12 Reference 4113 watches were pro-



duced in the 1940s, and only nine are confirmed to have survived. It remains the brand's only vintage split-seconds chronograph and has long been linked to motor racing circles, with several examples historically owned by drivers and team principals.

Ali Nael, CEO of FutureGrail, said: "This sale is one of the most significant in auction history, breaking a world-record and underlining the demand from luxury watch collectors across the globe. It is a privilege to bring such a rare item to the market, demonstrating that from Geneva to Dubai to Singapore, watches of this calibre command incredible interest. We may not see a Rolex Reference 4113 of this quality come to market for a long time."

SPORT

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